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W E D N E S D A Y , A P R I L 3 0 , 2 0 2 5

Employers panicking about who will do work

Many rely on immigrants and fear they'll be gone

By Katie Johnston and Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

As Washington escalates its broad crack-down on immigrants, Boston-area employers are getting increasingly anxious.

They're tightening employment verification for new hires. They're devising code words to warn workers to hide if federal agents show up. One restaurant owner in suburban Boston has been working the phones, doing everything she can to protect a worker who was ordered to self-deport. It's thrown the kitchen staff into turmoil, with other workers worried they'll also be ensnared if ICE comes knocking.

"Even if you have your paperwork in order, they're revoking it," the owner said. "It's all bullying and we don't have any way to combat it."

And amid the chaos, business owners are beginning to wrestle with a difficult question: Who'll fill all their jobs if immigrants go away?

With many businesses — from construction and landscaping to hotels and gift shops — gearing up for spring, the Trump administration's revocation of protections for various immigrant groups is straining an already-tight labor market. A growing drumbeat of messaging from federal authorities that people here without permanent status should simply leave has many employers and advocates quietly wondering who exactly will wash dishes, clean office buildings, and staff nursing homes if

EMPLOYERS, Page A6

Canada split runs deeper than Trump

By Amanda Coletta
WASHINGTON POST

OTTAWA — In 2012, when Mark Carney left Canada to helm the Bank of England, he said he was going to where "the challenges are greatest." Those now facing him as Canada's prime minister are significant.

The five-week campaign and electoral map revealed a country with two dominant parties with starkly different agendas — and regional divisions that could test national unity as Canada confronts President Trump's trade war and annexation threats.

Carney, a former central banker, overcame a 20-plus-point polling deficit and rescued the Liberals from electoral annihilation, giving them a rare fourth consecutive term.

The Liberals did fall short of winning an outright majority in Parliament on Tuesday. The vote-counting agency Elections Canada finished processing nearly all ballots in an election that could leave the Liberals just three seats shy of a majority, which means they will have to seek help from another, smaller party to pass legislation.

The Liberals seemed likely to find the extra votes necessary, but it was not clear whether they would come from the progressive party or

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Harvard reports show deep anger

Jewish students decry treatment by peers while pro-Palestinians cite abandonment by school

By Mike Damiano and Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

Jewish students described being treated as pariahs. Arab and Muslim students said they felt like "second-class citizens." Both groups said their peers viewed them with suspicion, leading them to play down their identities.

Those were some of the findings of two searing reports on antisemitism and anti-Arab or anti-Muslim

bias that Harvard University released Tuesday in the midst of its extraordinary confrontation with the Trump administration, which has accused the school of violating the civil rights of its Jewish students.

Work on the reports began last year at the height of the campus protests over the Israel-Hamas war, and they largely describe events of the previous academic year.

Nonetheless, the findings on the

climate for Jewish students in particular may bolster the Trump administration's accusation that Harvard violated their civil rights by failing to protect them from antisemitic harassment and discrimination.

The reports were originally to be released last fall. But, following delays, the Trump administration demanded on April 19 that Harvard turn over all documents, including any drafts and edits, related to the

antisemitism report.

Even before its current confrontation with President Trump, Harvard took pains to highlight its actions to combat antisemitism, including revamping campus rules related to protest and student discipline. Some Jewish students say the climate has significantly improved since last year.

In an open letter Tuesday, Harvard president Alan Garber emphasized

HARVARD, Page A7

BASK TO BASK



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

It's still April but you'd never have known it if you were outside Tuesday. Even Boston reached 79, so Berklee College of Music students Anna Tandy (left) and Sophi Allen took a break from classes to get a bench on the Common.

Deal with state on BPS oversight soon up

Progress made in 3 years but some say it's far from enough

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Three years after the state declared Boston was failing to serve its most vulnerable students and brokered a deal with Mayor Michelle Wu for the district to fix its schools to avoid a state takeover, the agreement is being allowed to expire — despite problems the district has yet to resolve.

The state, in 2022, charged Boston Public Schools with fixing chronic dysfunction it had outlined in an au-

dit just weeks prior to the agreement, which included the district's failure to provide adequate services to English learners and students in special education. The plan was sweeping in that it also identified needed improvements outside the classroom, such as more buses running on time and better long-term planning for the future use of its facilities, for which the state reports incremental growth.

But the district hasn't fulfilled all of its commitments under the agreement, including for special education and English learners.

The deal expires in June despite widespread gaps remaining between Black and Latino students, compared to their white and Asian classmates. Critics, including some education and

policy advocates and district families, argue that BPS students deserve heightened state oversight of the city's schools. There must be greater focus on improvements to teaching, said those critics, including Marty Walz, the interim president of the Boston Municipal Research Bureau.

"The operational improvements since 2020 do not justify the state scaling back its role, especially when one considers the district's academic performance," Walz said. "More, not less, state oversight and accountability for Boston Public Schools is required."

Wu and Superintendent Mary Skipper, in an interview together with the Globe on Monday, both argued

BOSTON SCHOOLS, Page A7

President Trump celebrated the 100th day of his second term — yet spent much of his rally fixated on past grudges. Meanwhile, China vowed it would "never kneel down" to his tariff pressure. **A2-3.**

Senator Elizabeth Warren demanded the private equity buyer of Walgreens explain how it will prevent the closure of Massachusetts pharmacies. **B5.**



A blast like the past

The chain is long dead, but a Ground Round has returned to Massachusetts, in Shrewsbury. Devra First looks for the old magic. **G1.**

April wower

Wednesday: Sunny, pleasant. High 68-73. Low 43-48.

Thursday: Cloudy, cooler. High 58-63. Low 48-53.

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

MOVING ON — After a slow start in Game 5 Tuesday night at TD Garden, the Celtics came alive in the second half and finished off Orlando, 120-89, taking the first-round playoff series 4-1. Boston's next opponent hasn't been determined yet. **C1.**

Healey has taken no action on commuting 4 sentences

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

Last summer, a state board made one of Massachusetts' rarest political recommendations: William Florentino, convicted in 1978 of taking part in a deadly robbery, should be released from his first-degree murder sentence. Then it told Governor Maura Healey that Edward Fielding — convicted 50 years ago of first-degree murder — should also have his sentence commuted.

It's still unclear when, or if, they will. The men are among four convicted of murder whose sentences the Advisory Board of Pardons recommended that Healey commute, endorsing an act of mercy that effectively releases a person from their sentence and can help clear the way for their freedom.

Yet the first-term Democrat has yet to issue a decision in each of the cases,

which landed on her desk anywhere from five to nearly 18 months ago. The board had also recommended a fifth man have his sentence commuted last fall, but he was paroled before Healey acted.

Such gubernatorial reprieves have long been uncommon. Healey's five immediate predecessors combined to grant just four, with Charlie Baker, a Republican, accounting for three of them.

Commutations typically involve those convicted of some of the most violent crimes — murder, assault, armed robbery — adding a layer of moral and political complexity to a governor's decision. In the cases before Healey, they've also drawn resistance from victim's families, who've urged state officials not to release their relative's killers.

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